

ATTRACTION: Ruins of Nalanda University

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Nalanda Mahavihara

LOCATION:

Nalanda

DISTRICT / REGION:

Nalanda

CATEGORY:

Historical Site / Heritage Site / Educational Site

OVERVIEW:

The Ruins of Nalanda University mark the site of the renowned mahavihara (Buddhist monastic university) in ancient Magadha, modern-day Bihar. Considered by historians to be the world's first residential university and among the greatest centers of learning in the ancient world, it operated from 427 until 1197 CE. Located near the ancient city of Rajagriha (Rajgir), Nalanda played a critical role in promoting arts and academics during India's "Golden Age" and was home to some of the most revered scholars of Mahayana Buddhism.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Nalanda Mahavihara, located about 90 kilometres southeast of Pataliputra (modern Patna) near Rajgir, was an epicenter of intellectual pursuit. Operating from 427 until 1197 CE, it is celebrated as the world's first residential university. During the 5th and 6th centuries, often termed the "Golden Age of India," the institution played a vital role in promoting academic excellence and the patronage of arts. For approximately 750 years, the university's faculty was composed of some of the most revered scholars of Mahayana Buddhism. The curriculum was vast, teaching six major Buddhist schools and philosophies including Yogachara and Sarvastivada, as well as secular subjects such as grammar, medicine, logic, and mathematics. The ruins stand today as a testament to this incredible legacy of ancient learning.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

Nalanda University holds unparalleled historical and cultural significance. It was one of the greatest centers of learning in the ancient world and the world's first residential university. It was a crucial pillar of the "Golden Age of India," attracting scholars and students from across the globe and playing a fundamental role in the development and spread of Mahayana Buddhism and various secular sciences.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

Not Mentioned

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- World's first residential university.
- Operated from 427 until 1197 CE.
- Central hub of learning during the "Golden Age of India" (5th and 6th century CE).
- Faculty included revered scholars of Mahayana Buddhism.
- Taught six major Buddhist philosophies (including Yogachara and Sarvastivada) along with grammar, medicine, logic, and mathematics.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit: October to March

Opening Hours: 09:00AM - 04:45PM

Entry Fee: Rs. 40 (Domestic), Rs. 600 (Foreign)

Duration Recommended: Not Mentioned
Photography: Photography & Videography Allowed
Accessibility Information: Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

- Parking
- Restaurants
- Drinking Water
- Videography & Photography Allowed
- Souvenir Shop

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport: Patna (86 Kms)
Nearest Railway Station: Nalanda (03 Kms)
Nearest Bus Stand: Nalanda (02 Kms)
Road Connectivity: Located about 90 kilometres southeast of Pataliputra (Patna)
Nearest Tourist Information Centre: Tourist Information Centre, Nalanda
Nearest Police Station: Nalanda (03 Kms), Ph : 06112-281827
Nearest Medical Facility: Sadar Hospital, Biharsharif, Ph : 06112-236779

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Old University Museum
- Huien Tsang Memorial Hall
- Swetambar Temple (02 Kms)
- Chini Buddha (02 Kms)
- Sun Temple (01 Km)
- Thai Buddhist Temple (01 Km)
- Sun Bound (01 Km)
- Black Buddha (01 Km)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Exploring the rich educational and Buddhist heritage of ancient India.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Souvenir Shop available.

ACCOMMODATION:

- Hotel Rajgir Residency
- Hotel Indo Hokke
- Hotel Nalanda Residency
- Hotel Kripanidhi
- Hotel Vijay

HOTELS:

- Hotel Rajgir Residency

- Hotel Indo Hokke
- Hotel Nalanda Residency
- Hotel Kripanidhi
- Hotel Vijay

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Santosh Kumar, Mob : 9801399926
- Shiv Priye, Mob : 9334943534
- Sanjay Kr. Pandey, Mob : 9308051657
- Praveen Kumar, Mob : 7301502535
- Sanjay Kumar, Mob : 8434153559
- Praveen Kumar, Mob : 9155764270
- Pradeep Kumar, Mob : 9934051597
- Aditya Kumar, Mob : 9931271352
- Navin Kumar, Mob : 7903580307
- Sanjay Kumar, Mob : 9608646853
- Pravin Kumar, Mob : 9955393911

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Taxi Operator: NOT AVAILABLE

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- The university operated continuously for over 750 years.
- It was a pioneer in subjects like logic, mathematics, and medicine alongside Buddhist theology.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

The Ruins of Nalanda University mark the location of the ancient Nalanda Mahavihara, considered the world's first residential university. Operating from 427 to 1197 CE during India's "Golden Age," it was a premier global center for learning, teaching Buddhist philosophies (Yogachara, Sarvastivada) alongside medicine, logic, and mathematics. Visitors can explore the ruins from October to March between 09:00 AM and 04:45 PM. The entry fee is Rs. 40 for domestic tourists and Rs. 600 for foreigners. The site is located 03 Kms from Nalanda Railway Station and 86 Kms from Patna Airport. Nearby attractions include the Old University Museum and Huien Tsang Memorial Hall.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known as the world's first residential university and one of the greatest centers of learning in ancient India, operating from 427 to 1197 CE.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in Nalanda, near Rajgir in modern-day Bihar, about 90 kms southeast of Patna.

Q: What are the nearby attractions?

A: Nearby attractions include Old University Museum, Huien Tsang Memorial Hall, Swetambar Temple, Chini Buddha, and Thai Buddhist Temple.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: Visitors can reach via Patna Airport (86 Kms) or Nalanda Railway Station (03 Kms).

Q: What facilities are available?

A: Facilities include parking, restaurants, drinking water, souvenir shop, and photography/videography.

KEYWORDS:

Ruins of Nalanda University, Nalanda Mahavihara, Magadha, Golden Age of India, Buddhist Monastic University, Mahayana Buddhism, Yogachara, Sarvastivada, Huien Tsang Memorial Hall.

